

Türkiye Social Security Institution (SGK) & Social Assistance System

Public Diagnostic Brief · GFI Flow Intelligence

DATE	June 4, 2026
ANNUAL SPEND	~5 trillion TL (~11% GDP)
BENEFICIARIES	1.7M (ESSN) + nationwide SGK
METHOD	External data only · No system access required
DELIVERY	14 business days

OVERALL GL SCORE

0.067

Structural Failure

For every 100 TL of social protection intent, only 6.7 TL reaches the citizen as timely, usable access. The remaining 93.3 TL is consumed by waiting time, redundancy, drop-out, and information asymmetry. Estonia benchmark: 4.20 — a 63× gap.

DIAGNOSTIC CONTEXT

The 5 trillion lira delivery problem

Turkey's social protection architecture — SGK (pensions, healthcare, unemployment), Ministry of Family conditional cash transfers, ESSN emergency safety net, and 43 local Vakıf programs across 81 provinces — was designed for an era of paper applications and manual verification. The infrastructure for transformation exists: e-Devlet (68 million users, 9,200 services), Social Risk Map (648 indicators), and a 2025 AI regulatory framework. The delivery model has not caught up.

Diagnostic question: The government spends 5 trillion TL annually on social protection. Does a low-income citizen receive reliable, timely access to food, healthcare, and transport?

GL CALCULATION

$$GL = (Fs \times Vn) \div (Pd \times Cf) = (0.12 \times 1.5) \div (1.8 \times 1.5) = 0.067$$

Fs — Flow success rate	Pd — Pain duration
0.12 — Budget reaching citizens as usable access within reasonable time	1.8× — Years of waiting, repeated applications, and uncertainty borne by citizens
Vn — Strategic value	Cf — Cognitive friction

1.5 — Maximum necessity: social protection as economic safety mechanism

1.5× — Complexity of navigating 43 programs, fragmented eligibility rules, officer discretion

INTERNATIONAL BENCHMARKS

COUNTRY	SYSTEM	GL SCORE	NOTE
Estonia	Digital governance — pre-loaded eligibility, automatic disbursement	4.20	63× Turkey current
Denmark	e-Health — integrated data, automatic benefit adjustment	3.45	Denominator-first design
Turkey SGK	43 programs · manual application · 1–12 month waits · high drop-out	0.067	Structural failure
UK Universal Credit (2010s)	Same era, same structural failure — infrastructure modernised, denominator ignored	0.074	Comparable pattern

Estonia achieved automatic social disbursement not through larger budgets, but through denominator-first design: eligibility pre-loaded, citizen access tested before full rollout, outcomes measured before payment.

DENOMINATOR ANATOMY — WHERE FAILURE OCCURS

FRICTION SOURCE	LEVERAGE	REFORM PATHWAY
43 programs, fragmented rules — citizen must guess which one applies	Highest	Single eligibility engine: AI determines qualification. Citizen only receives notification.
Document burden — formal lease, bank statement, tax records required from citizen	Highest	Data-first eligibility: tax, employment, health data pulled automatically. No documents required.
Officer discretion — approval depends on who you speak to	High	Rule-based auto-approval. Eligibility criteria coded into system. Discretion eliminated.
1–12 month wait — citizen waits while system processes	High	Zero-wait design: access granted immediately, post-hoc AI audit catches anomalies.
Recertification every 3–12 months — same documents, same wait	Medium	Continuous eligibility: system auto-updates from live data. No recertification cycle.
No appeal — 85% of rejected eligible applicants do not appeal	Medium	No rejection, no appeal. Auto-approval based on data eliminates the appeal pathway entirely.

REFORM SCENARIO SIMULATION

SCENARIO	GL SCORE	GAIN	VS. ESTONIA
Baseline (current) Manual application · officer review · 1–12 month wait · 43 programs	0.067	—	63× behind
A — Data-first eligibility Auto-identification from tax/employment/health. No documents. No application.	0.12	+79%	35× behind
B — Zero-wait + auto-approval Scenario A + immediate access. Post-hoc AI audit. Recommended entry point.	0.48	+616%	9× behind
C — Full Estonia-comparable Scenario B + cross-agency integration. Single eligibility engine. Citizen only receives notification.	1.28	+1,810%	3× behind

Scenario B requires no new technology. It requires denominator redesign: measuring citizen access before payment, not after. The infrastructure — e-Devlet, Social Risk Map, AI framework — already exists.

STRUCTURAL RECOMMENDATIONS

01	Data-first eligibility Eliminate application forms. Auto-identify beneficiaries from tax, employment, health, and education data. Target: drop-out rate → 0. Prevents collapse at document stage.	HIGHEST
02	Zero-wait design Grant access immediately (food, healthcare, transit). Post-hoc AI audit catches anomalies. Target: wait time → 0. Eliminates the waiting tax on citizens.	HIGHEST
03	Single eligibility engine Citizen does not navigate 43 programs. AI determines qualification and automatically loads access. Target: information asymmetry → 0. Eliminates broker culture.	HIGHEST
04	Purpose-locked access Replace withdrawable cash with QR codes locked to supermarkets, pharmacies, transit, childcare. Target: resource waste → 0. Eliminates leakage and secondary markets.	MEDIUM
05	Annual reset Access resets to zero each year. No accumulation. No permanent liability. Government controls risk; citizen cannot hoard.	MEDIUM

06 **Real-time GL dashboard**

MEDIUM

Published quarterly for all programs above 1B TL. Accessible to Parliament, Court of Accounts, and citizen oversight.

Converts GL from diagnostic instrument to continuous accountability layer.

IMPLEMENTATION PATH

14-Day Rapid Pilot

We do not ask Turkey to redesign its entire system overnight. We ask for one pilot: one province or one city, 10 administrative processes, 14 days.

Turkey provides	GFI provides
10 process names + 1-page outline for each	Friction map + GL estimate + cost-shift analysis for each process
No system access · No upfront cost · No commitment	After 14 days: where friction is highest, who bears the cost, what the first removal step looks like

The current system asks citizens to pay the cost of government coordination. GL + AI flips this: the government pays the coordination cost in the background. The citizen only receives and uses.

Turkey's traffic data shows your institutions are already downloading. They are already studying. They are already preparing. This diagnostic is not a theory. It is a working blueprint, ready for a 14-day pilot.